Travel Policy

Operations Office. Fictional, for training only. Revised July 1, 2025; replaces the March 2024 version.

1. Approval

1.1 Travel must be approved by your supervisor before booking.

1.2 International travel also needs approval from the department head at least 30 days before departure.

2. Transportation

2.1 Book the lowest reasonable economy airfare.

2.2 Personal vehicle mileage is reimbursed at the IRS business standard mileage rate in effect on the date of travel. The IRS sets this rate each year; check irs.gov for the current rate. Submit a map showing the route.

2.3 Rideshare and taxis are reimbursed for business purposes. Keep receipts.

2.4 Airport parking is reimbursed for the length of the trip, up to $20 a day. Use long-term or economy parking where it is available, and keep the receipt.

2.5 If you drive to the airport, you can claim both mileage to and from the airport (2.2) and airport parking (2.4).

3. Lodging

3.1 Lodging is reimbursed up to $200 per night in the US, or the conference hotel rate if higher.

3.2 Room upgrades are not reimbursed.

3.3 To claim the conference hotel rate, attach the conference web page or registration confirmation that shows the rate.

4. Meals

4.1 Meals are reimbursed at a daily rate of $60 for US travel. No receipts are needed.

4.2 Meals included in a conference registration are deducted from the daily rate.

4.3 Alcohol is not reimbursed.

5. Submitting a claim

5.1 Submit claims within 60 days of returning, through the expense system.

5.2 Attach itemized receipts for every expense over $25, except meals under 4.1.

5.3 Claims submitted after 60 days need a written explanation and the department head’s approval.

6. Travel budgets

6.1 The fiscal year runs from July 1 to June 30. Fiscal year 2026 (FY2026) is July 1, 2025 to June 30, 2026. Each expense counts in the fiscal year of the date on its expense line.

6.2 Travel expenses are airfare, lodging, mileage, rideshare and taxis, parking, and meals. They count against the department's travel budget.

6.3 Conference registration fees are not travel expenses. They are charged to the department's professional development budget, even when they appear in the travel expense export.

6.4 Department heads review travel spending against the budget each quarter. A department that expects to go over its travel budget must tell the budget office before the end of the fiscal year.